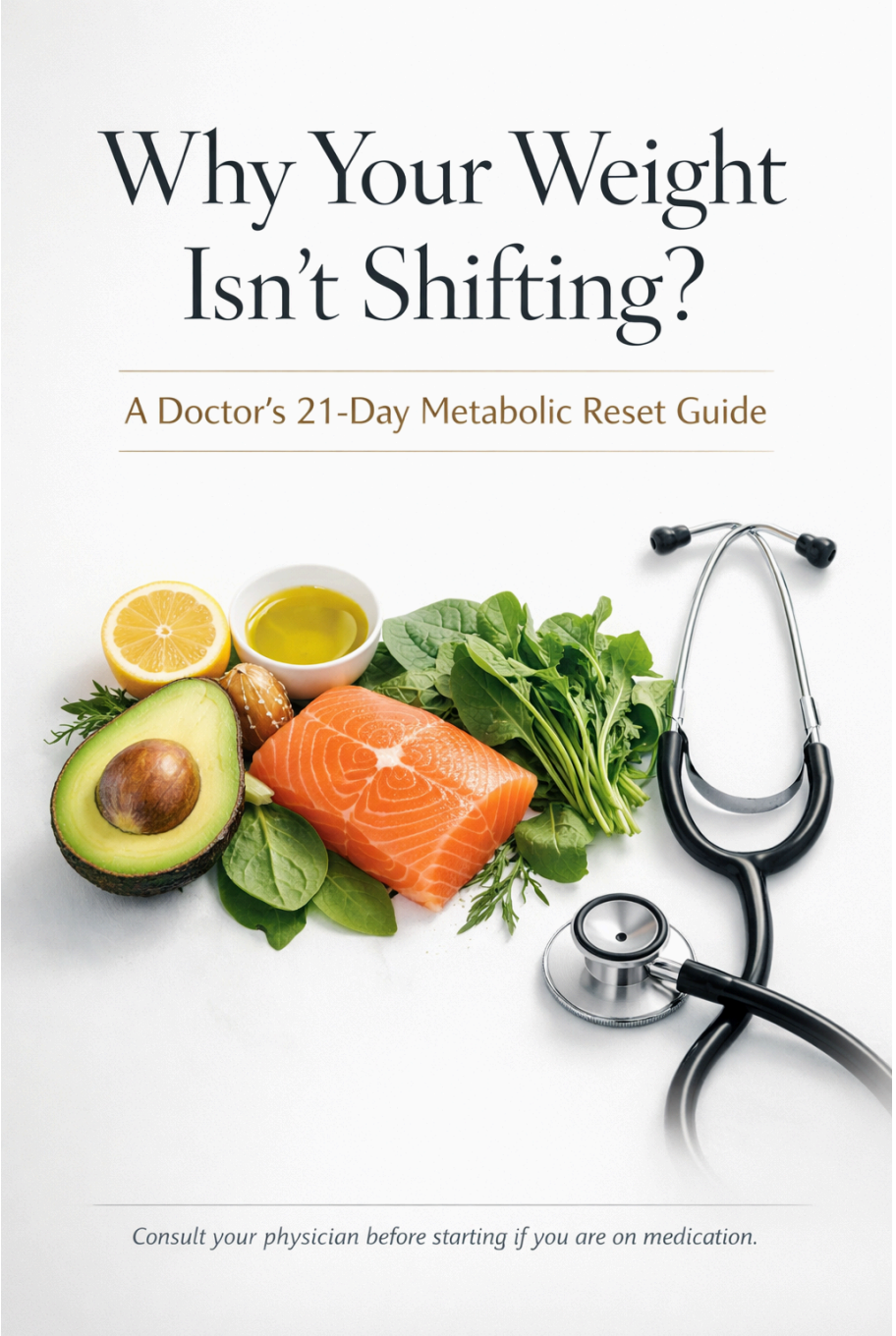
Why Your Weight Isn’t Shifting?

A Doctor’s 21-Day Metabolic Reset Guide

Lower Blood Sugar · Ease Blood Pressure · Get Your Energy Back



> *This is for adults 40+ experiencing metabolic decline — including insulin resistance, type 2 diabetes risk, fatigue, stubborn weight, poor sleep, and digestive issues. It is for informational purposes only and does not replace professional medical advice. If you are on medication, please consult your physician before making any changes. [Book your metabolic baseline assessment here]*

⚠️ IMPORTANT SAFETY NOTE — READ BEFORE STARTING

Talk to your clinician first if you:

- [ ] Take insulin or sulfonylureas (e.g., Gliclazide)
- [ ] Take SGLT2 inhibitors (e.g., Forxiga, Jardiance)
- [ ] Take blood pressure medication
- [ ] Have kidney disease (your doctor may call this having an eGFR below 60)
- [ ] Have a history of eating disorders
- [ ] Are pregnant or breastfeeding
- [ ] Have had a recent cardiac event
- [ ] Have type 1 diabetes

Why this matters: Reducing carbohydrates and fasting can lower your blood sugar and blood pressure, sometimes quickly. If you are on medication for these conditions, your doses may need to be adjusted by your doctor to avoid them dropping to unsafe levels.

What's Inside Your Guide

This guide is packed with actionable strategies and visual tools to help you on your metabolic reset journey:

WHAT'S INSIDE
Your Guide

21-Day Roadmap

Step-by-step plan

Protein-First Plate Template

Balanced meal guide

Fasting Cheat Sheets

Timing strategies

Movement Tiers

Activity levels

Busy Day Emergency Plan

Quick solutions

FAQ & Rapid Reset Guide

Expert answers

Section	What you get
PERC Framework	4 pillars: Prepare, Eat & Eliminate, Reset, Condition
21-Day Roadmap	Day-by-day action plan across 3 phases
7-Day Meal Plan	Clean, real-food meals available in any supermarket
Protein Guide	Clean whey protein options + food sources
Gut-Health Layer	Fermented foods and prebiotics to support digestion
Fasting Cheat Sheet	Two tracks — beginner and advanced
Movement Ladder	3 tiers from sedentary to active
Supplement Stack	Sleep and gut support stack
Shopping List	One-page printable by category
21-Day Tracker	Daily tick-box habit tracker
Weekly Reflection	3-week progress review template
Busy Day Plan	Stripped-back fallback for chaotic days
Rapid Reset Protocol	How to recover from a slip in 24–48 hours
FAQ / EPQ	Common questions answered honestly
Glossary of Terms	Simple explanations for key medical terms and UK medications

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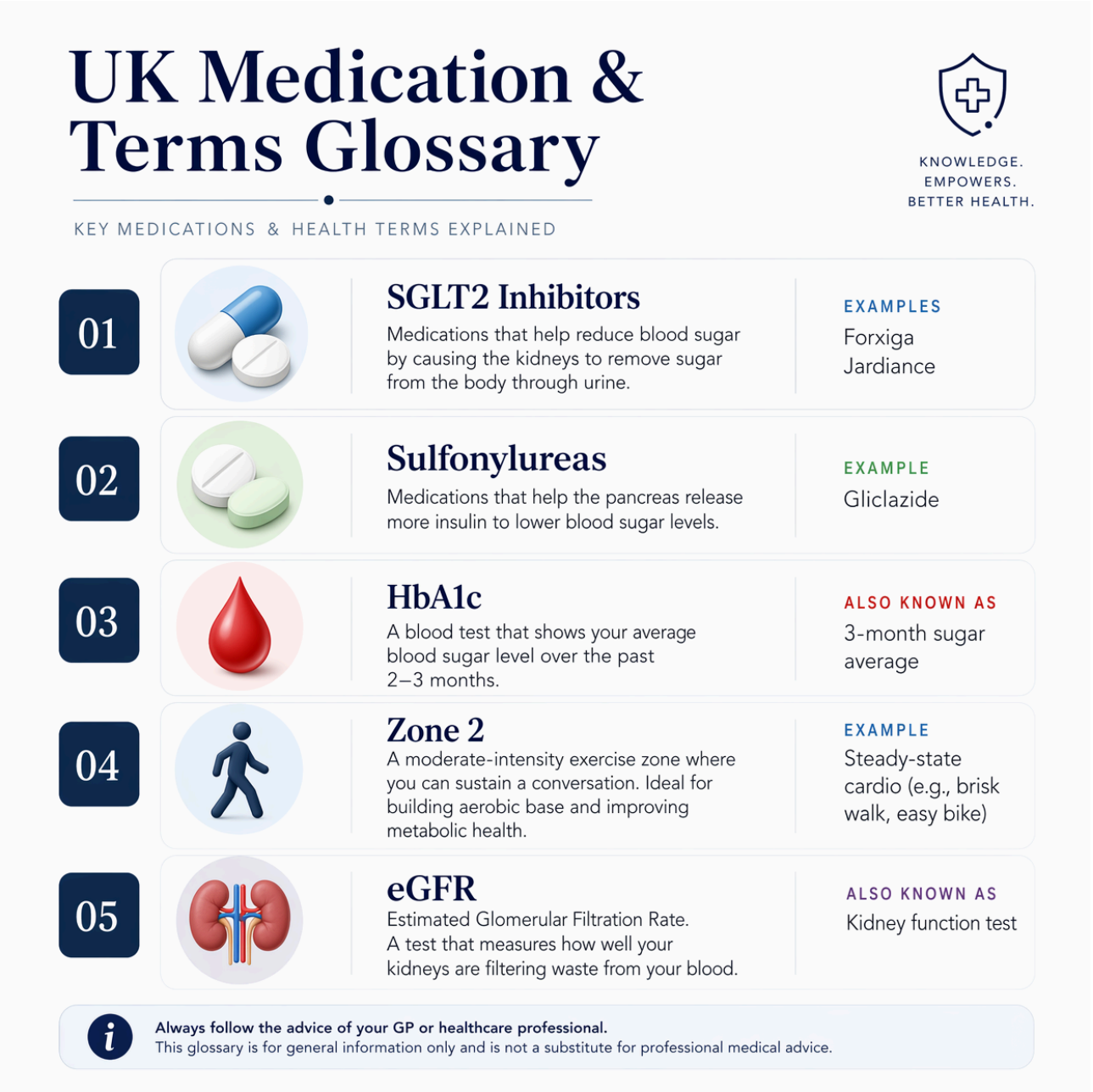
UK Medication & Terms Glossary



PART ONE: THE PERC FRAMEWORK

P — PREPARE & PERSONALISE

Your 5-Minute Baseline (Complete Before Day 1)

Record these numbers and keep them somewhere accessible:

Measure	Your number	Date
Weight (kg)		
Waist circumference (cm)		
Blood pressure (if available)		
HbA1c (if known)		
Fasting glucose (if known)		
Energy level (1–10)		
Sleep quality (1–10)		
Digestive comfort (1–10)		
Cravings intensity (1–10)		

Recheck everything on Day 21 and Day 42 (if repeating the reset).

Your Non-Negotiable Minimums

When life becomes chaotic, maintain these as your absolute floor:

- [ ] 12-hour overnight fast
- [ ] One protein-first meal today
- [ ] No sugary drinks
- [ ] One 10-minute walk after a main meal

Your Kitchen Reset (Before Day 1)

Remove or put away:

- [ ] Sugary drinks, juice, squash
- [ ] Biscuits, sweets, pastries, cereal bars
- [ ] Highly processed snack foods
- [ ] Bread (except a small sourdough loaf if needed)
- [ ] Processed cereals
- [ ] Seed oils: rapeseed/canola, sunflower, soybean, corn, cottonseed, generic vegetable oil

Stock up on:

- [ ] Eggs (free-range, pastured where possible)
- [ ] Wild-caught salmon, sardines, mackerel, tuna
- [ ] Grass-fed beef or lamb mince
- [ ] Chicken thighs or breast
- [ ] Full-fat, unsweetened Greek-style yogurt
- [ ] Cottage cheese
- [ ] Spinach, rocket, mixed salad leaves
- [ ] Broccoli, cauliflower, courgettes
- [ ] Peppers, mushrooms, green beans, asparagus
- [ ] Avocados
- [ ] Olives and extra-virgin olive oil
- [ ] Coconut oil or ghee for cooking
- [ ] Butter or tallow
- [ ] Berries (fresh or frozen)
- [ ] Lentils, chickpeas, or black beans (tinned, rinsed)
- [ ] Sauerkraut or kimchi (live/unpasteurised if available)
- [ ] Kefir (if dairy is tolerated)
- [ ] Garlic and onions
- [ ] A quality electrolyte supplement without sugars or artificial sweeteners
- [ ] Magnesium glycinate capsules (optional, for sleep)

E — EAT & ELIMINATE

The Metabolic Reset Plate

Build every main meal like this:

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                          │
│   35–40%                  35%                  25–30%    │
│  PROTEIN              NON-STARCHY             HEALTHY    │
│                        VEGETABLES           FATS + LOW   │
│  Fish · Eggs ·                               GI CARBS    │
│  Poultry · Beef ·      Greens · Broccoli ·              |
│  Lamb · Dairy          Courgette · Peppers · Olive oil ·|
│                        Mushrooms · Asparagus  Avocado · |
│                                              Nuts ·      |
│                                              Berries ·   |
│                                              Lentils     |
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Protein first: aim for at least 25–35 g of protein per meal.

Aim for **1.2–2.0 g/kg/day** of protein, distributed across meals. For an 80 kg person, that means roughly 95–160 g total daily. Three meals of 30–40 g each gets you there.

Protein-First Food List

Source	Protein per 100g	Notes
Wild-caught salmon	~20 g	Also high in omega-3
Sardines (tinned)	~25 g	Budget-friendly, excellent omega-3
Tuna (tinned in water or olive oil)	~25 g	Easy staple
Mackerel	~18 g	Wild-caught preferred
Chicken breast	~31 g	Versatile, lean
Chicken thigh	~26 g	More flavourful, slightly higher fat
Grass-fed beef mince	~26 g	Rich in CLA and B12
Grass-fed steak	~27 g	Excellent nutrient density
Lamb mince or chops	~25 g	Good iron and zinc
Eggs (2 large)	~12 g	Nutrient-dense, cheap, fast
Greek yogurt (full fat)	~10 g per 100g	Use as base or snack
Thick, high-protein natural yogurt	~11 g per 100g	Thicker, high protein
Cottage cheese	~11 g per 100g	Versatile, high satiety

Not in this guide as primary proteins: tofu, soy mince, processed plant-based meats, or fake meats of any kind.

Cooking Fats

Cook with	Finish / dress with
Coconut oil (virgin)	Extra-virgin olive oil
Ghee	Avocado oil
Butter (grass-fed where possible)	Avocado (whole food)
Beef tallow	Olives

Never use: rapeseed oil, canola oil, sunflower oil, soybean oil, corn oil, cottonseed oil, or generic “vegetable oil.”

Low-GI Carbohydrate Options (Small Portions)

- Lentils, chickpeas, black beans, kidney beans
- Berries (blueberries, raspberries, strawberries)
- Sweet potato (small portion, not daily for strict reset)
- Carrots (cooked; higher GI raw, but fine in a protein-first meal)
- Quinoa (small side serving)
- Steel-cut or rolled oats (optional, only if not fasting that morning)
- Sourdough bread: a small slice of genuine long-fermented sourdough is the lowest-GI bread option if bread is needed — use sparingly and not daily

Note on overnight oats: Acceptable on non-fasting days as a protein-boosted breakfast (mix with Greek yogurt and berries). Skip entirely on fasting days.

Foods to Remove for 21 Days

Category	Remove
Sugars	All added sugars, syrups, honey in drinks, sweets
Drinks	All sugary drinks, juice, alcohol
Refined grains	White bread, pasta, white rice, standard cereals
Ultra-processed	Crisps, biscuits, ready meals, fast food
Seed oils	Rapeseed, canola, sunflower, soybean, corn, vegetable oil
Dairy (initial elimination)	Remove for Days 1–14, then reintroduce carefully
Gluten-containing grains	Remove for Days 1–14 if digestive symptoms exist

Gut-Health Bonus Layer

Add these daily — they do not break fasting rules and support microbiome diversity:

- **One fermented food:** sauerkraut, kimchi, kefir (if tolerated), live yogurt
- **One prebiotic food:** garlic, onions, leeks, asparagus, chicory root, small portion of legumes

Clean Whey Protein — What to Look For

If using a protein powder supplement, look for:

- **Whey protein isolate** as the base (not concentrate where possible — lower in lactose and processing)
- **Short ingredient list** (ideally 2–5 ingredients)
- **No maltodextrin** — a cheap bulking agent with a very high glycaemic index
- **No artificial sweeteners in large amounts** — sucralose and acesulfame-K are common; minimal or absent is ideal
- **No proprietary blends hiding filler content**

**Always check labels for purity and ensure they meet the criteria above.

How to use: Mix with water or unsweetened almond/oat milk, or stir into full-fat Greek yogurt for a high-protein breakfast. Use as a supplement to whole foods, not as a meal replacement for every sitting.

R — RESET WITH FASTING & REST

The Fasting Framework

This guide focuses on **time-restricted eating (TRE)**, which means eating all your meals within a specific window each day. This allows your body to switch from burning sugar to burning fat, improving metabolic flexibility.

Track A (Beginner / Busy):

- **12-hour overnight fast:** This is your minimum. Finish dinner by 8 PM, don't eat again until 8 AM. This is achievable for almost everyone.
- **14-hour overnight fast:** Once 12 hours feels easy, push to 14 hours. Finish dinner by 8 PM, eat again at 10 AM.

Track B (Advanced — only when comfortable and medically cleared):

- **16:8 Fasting:** Eat all your meals within an 8-hour window (e.g., 12 PM to 8 PM). This is a popular and effective TRE protocol.
- **Optional 20–24 hour fast:** For appropriate users, one dinner-to-dinner fast per week can accelerate results. **Only attempt this if you are medically cleared and comfortable with 16:8 fasting.**

During fasting windows, you may have:

- Water (still or sparkling)
- Black coffee (no milk, sugar, or sweeteners)
- Plain tea (herbal or green, no milk, sugar, or sweeteners)
- Bone broth (small amount, check ingredients for additives)
- Electrolytes (especially on longer fasts to prevent headaches and fatigue)

Avoid during fasting:

- Any food or drink with calories (even small amounts can break a fast)
- Artificial sweeteners (can trigger insulin response in some individuals)
- Milk or cream in coffee/tea

Sleep & Stress Reset

Sleep is as crucial as diet and exercise for metabolic health. Poor sleep increases insulin resistance and cravings.

- **Consistent Bedtime:** Go to bed and wake up at roughly the same time every day, even on weekends.
- **Reduce Caffeine:** Cut off caffeine intake by early afternoon (e.g., 2-3 PM).
- **Magnesium:** Consider 200–400 mg of magnesium glycinate 1-2 hours before bed (if suitable) to improve sleep quality.
- **Wind-Down Routine:** Create a relaxing evening routine: dim lights, avoid screens, read a book, take a warm bath.

C — CONDITION MUSCLES & METABOLISM

Movement is medicine. This section introduces accessible ways to improve your metabolic health through physical activity.

Movement Tiers

- **Level 1 (Foundation):** Two 5–10 minute walks daily. Start here if you are sedentary. Any movement counts!
- **Level 2 (Progress):** 20–30 minute Zone 2 walks or light rucking, 3–4 times weekly. Zone 2 is a moderate intensity where you can hold a conversation but

feel slightly breathless.

- **Level 3 (Peak):** 30–45 minute Zone 2 activity plus two short strength sessions weekly. Strength training builds muscle, which is metabolically active tissue.

Rule: Any movement counts; progress only when the current level feels easy.

Zone 2 Explained

Zone 2 training is about sustained, moderate-intensity exercise. It's not about going hard, but going long. You should be able to talk in full sentences, but with a slight breathiness. This improves your body's ability to burn fat for fuel.

PART TWO: 21-DAY ROADMAP

This section outlines your daily actions over the next 21 days. Each day builds upon the last, progressively introducing new habits and reinforcing existing ones. Remember to listen to your body and consult your doctor if you experience any concerns.

WHAT TO EXPECT — HONEST OUTCOMES BY WEEK

Based on published clinical data:

Marker	Week 1	Week 2–3	Notes
Weight	−1 to −3 kg	−1 to −2 kg more	Week 1 mostly water and glycogen
Fasting glucose	Drops within 24–72 hours	−1 to −2 mmol/L	Improves rapidly on calorie + carb deficit
Blood pressure	Early reduction possible	−5 to −10 mmHg SBP	DASH-like dietary effect within 2 weeks
Energy	Dip days 3–5, then improves	Stable daytime energy	Keto-adaptation peak at about day 10–14
Digestion	Variable during elimination	Improving by Week 2	Fermented foods help
HbA1c	**No meaningful change**	**No meaningful change**	Reflects 90-day average — recheck at 3 months

The honest framing: 21 days is a runway, not a cure. Your goal by Day 21 is momentum, proof-of-concept in your own body, and keystone habits that seed a 90-day consolidation.

PHASE 1 — THE SHIFT (Days 1–7)

Goal: Clean up the kitchen, establish protein-first meals, begin 12-hour overnight fast, start daily movement.

What to expect: Initial weight loss (mostly water), some carb cravings, potential

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Based on published clinical data:

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PHASE 1 — THE SHIFT (Days 1–7)

Goal: Clean up the kitchen, establish protein-first meals, begin 12-hour overnight fast, start daily movement.

What to expect: Initial weight loss (mostly water), some carb cravings, potential “keto flu” symptoms (headache, fatigue) as your body adapts. These are temporary and can be managed with electrolytes and hydration.

DAY 1

- [ ] **Kitchen Reset:** Remove or put away all trigger foods. Stock up on approved foods.
- [ ] **Baseline:** Record your initial weight, waist, energy, sleep, digestion, and cravings.
- [ ] **Eating:** First protein-first meal. Aim for 25–35g protein.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Begin your 12-hour overnight fast after dinner.
- [ ] **Movement:** Take a 10-minute walk after your biggest meal.

DAY 2

- [ ] **Eating:** Two protein-first meals. No snacking.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Maintain 12-hour overnight fast.
- [ ] **Movement:** Two 10-minute walks today.
- [ ] **Hydration:** Aim for 2–3 litres of water.

DAY 3

- [ ] **Eating:** Three protein-first meals. No snacking.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Maintain 12-hour overnight fast. Consider 14 hours if comfortable.
- [ ] **Movement:** Two 10-minute walks. Add a 20-minute Zone 2 walk if energy allows.
- [ ] **Gut Support:** Introduce one fermented food and one prebiotic food.

DAY 4

- [ ] **Eating:** Continue protein-first meals. Focus on consistency.

- [ ] **Fasting:** Maintain 12–14 hour overnight fast.
- [ ] **Movement:** 20–30 minute Zone 2 walk.
- [ ] **Sleep:** Aim for 7–8 hours of quality sleep.

DAY 5

- [ ] **Eating:** Continue protein-first meals. No snacking.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Maintain 12–14 hour overnight fast.
- [ ] **Movement:** Two 10-minute walks. Add a short strength session if comfortable.
- [ ] **Electrolytes:** Use if experiencing headaches or fatigue.

DAY 6 — Optional Fast Day (Track B)

- [ ] **Track A:** Continue with protein-first meals, 12–14 hour fast.
- [ ] **Track B (Advanced):** Consider a 16:8 fast or an optional 20–24 hour dinner-to-dinner fast (medically cleared only). Hydrate with water, black coffee, tea, electrolytes.
- [ ] **Movement:** Gentle walk only on fast day.

DAY 7 — Week 1 Review

- [ ] **Reflection:** Complete your Week 1 Reflection template.
- [ ] **Eating:** Review what worked and what was challenging.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Assess comfort with current fasting window.
- [ ] **Plan:** Adjust for Week 2 based on your reflection.

PHASE 2 — THE DEEP RESET (Days 8–14)

Goal: Increase consistency, deepen fasting, introduce more structured movement, fine-tune food choices.

What to expect: Energy levels should stabilise and improve. Cravings for sugar and refined carbs should reduce significantly. You may notice more consistent weight loss and improved digestion.

DAY 8

- [ ] **Eating:** Consolidate protein-first meals. No snacking.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Maintain 14-hour overnight fast. Consider 16:8 if comfortable.
- [ ] **Movement:** 30-minute Zone 2 walk or light rucking.

DAY 9

- [ ] **Eating:** Continue with clean eating. Focus on meal timing.
- [ ] **Movement:** Short strength session.
- [ ] **Hydration:** Ensure adequate water and electrolytes.

DAY 10

- [ ] **Eating:** Continue protein-first meals. Introduce a new prebiotic food.
- [ ] **Fasting:** Maintain 14–16 hour overnight fast.
- [ ] **Movement:** 30-minute Zone 2 walk.

DAY 11

- [ ] **Eating:** Focus on mindful eating — chew slowly, put your fork down between bites.
- [ ] **Movement:** Two 10-minute walks. Add a short strength session if comfortable.
- [ ] **Sleep:** Review your bedtime routine.

DAY 12 — Optional Fast Day (Track B)

- [ ] **Track A:** Continue with protein-first meals, 14–16 hour fast.

- [ ] **Track B (Advanced):** Consider a 16:8 fast or an optional 20–24 hour dinner-to-dinner fast (medically cleared only). Hydrate with water, black coffee, tea, electrolytes.
- [ ] **Movement:** Gentle walk only on fast day.

DAY 13

- [ ] **Eating:** Continue with clean eating. Experiment with new protein sources.
- [ ] **Movement:** 30-minute Zone 2 walk or light rucking.
- [ ] **Gut Support:** Ensure daily fermented and prebiotic foods.

DAY 14 — Week 2 Review

- [ ] Record weight, waist, energy, digestion, sleep, cravings
- [ ] Note: blood sugar and blood pressure changes may already be measurable if you have a home device
- [ ] Plan: which meals worked best? Which days were hardest?
- [ ] Celebrate any wins — including non-scale victories (better sleep, less bloating, steadier energy)

PHASE 3 — DEEPEN AND CONSOLIDATE (Days 15–21)

Goal: Solidify habits, increase movement load slightly, personalise food tolerance, plan the next phase.

What to expect: Metabolic flexibility emerges — smoother transitions between energy sources, stable daytime energy without crashes, reduced carb cravings, measurable waist reduction.

DAY 15

- [ ] **Movement:** Increase Zone 2 to 35–40 minutes or introduce light rucking

- [ ] **Eating:** Begin reintroducing dairy carefully if you removed it — one serving at a time, observe for 48 hours

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DAY 16

- [ ] **Eating:** If dairy reintroduction caused no reaction, continue. If bloating or symptoms return, remove again
- [ ] **Movement:** Strength session — push slightly harder, add a set or extra reps
- [ ] **Fasting:** Consolidate your chosen track — make it automatic

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DAY 17

- [ ] **Movement:** Zone 2 session 35–40 minutes
- [ ] **Mindset:** 10 minutes of slow breathing (6 breaths per minute) — reduces blood pressure by approximately 6 mmHg SBP in consistent practice (meta-analysis evidence)

DAY 18 — Optional Extended Fast Day (Track B)

- [ ] Same protocol as Days 6 and 12 for Track B

DAY 19

- [ ] **Movement:** Strength session
- [ ] **Eating:** How is your energy 2 hours after meals? Still getting a crash? If yes, reduce carbohydrate portion slightly

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DAY 20

- [ ] **Movement:** Longest Zone 2 session of the programme — 40–50 minutes if able
- [ ] **Gut support:** Continue fermented + prebiotic foods daily — this should be an embedded habit by now

- [ ] **Sleep:** One final sleep optimisation check — temperature, timing, magnesium, caffeine cutoff

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DAY 21 — Final Assessment and 90-Day Launch

- [ ] Recheck all baseline measures: weight, waist, BP, glucose, energy, sleep, digestion, cravings
- [ ] Compare with Day 1 baseline
- [ ] Write your 90-day plan: which habits will you keep? What will you continue to improve?
- [ ] Set a clinician appointment for HbA1c recheck at 3 months if you have diabetes or pre-diabetes

You are now at the beginning of the real reset. Day 21 is the launch pad, not the finish line.

PART THREE: 7-DAY MEAL PLAN

All meals use whole, unprocessed, real foods. No soy, no seed oils, no processed vegetarian substitutes, no tofu.

WEEK 1 MEAL PLAN (Days 1–7)

DAY 1

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	3 scrambled eggs in butter, handful of spinach, half an avocado
Lunch	Tinned wild-caught sardines or tuna with salad (rocket, cucumber, cherry tomatoes), drizzled with olive oil and lemon
Dinner	Grass-fed beef mince stir-fried in coconut oil with broccoli, courgette, garlic, and mushrooms
Snack (if needed)	Full-fat Greek yogurt with a handful of blueberries

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DAY 2

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	2 poached eggs on a bed of wilted spinach, cooked in butter
Lunch	Leftover beef mince with salad leaves and olive oil
Dinner	Wild-caught salmon fillet baked or pan-fried in coconut oil, with roasted asparagus and cauliflower
Snack (if needed)	Small handful of mixed nuts (walnuts, almonds)

DAY 3

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	Full-fat skyr with berries and a tablespoon of ground flaxseed
Lunch	Chicken thigh (roasted or grilled), green salad, half avocado, olive oil dressing
Dinner	Lamb mince with courgette noodles (spiralised or ribboned with a peeler), garlic, and fresh herbs
Snack (if needed)	Cottage cheese with cucumber slices

DAY 4

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	3-egg omelette with mushrooms, onions, and a little butter
Lunch	Tinned mackerel (in olive oil or brine) with roasted peppers and a small portion of lentils
Dinner	Grass-fed steak (any cut) cooked in butter or tallow, with green beans and a side salad
Snack (if needed)	Greek yogurt

PART FOUR: SUPPLEMENT STACK

Supplements support but do not replace the food, fasting, sleep, and movement plan.

Tier 1 — Sleep and Basic Support (Gentle, Evidence-Based)

Supplement	Dose	Timing	Evidence
Magnesium glycinate or bisglycinate	200–400 mg elemental	1–2 hours before bed	RCTs show reduced sleep latency, improved sleep quality, lower cortisol
Electrolytes (sodium, potassium, magnesium)	Per sachet guidance	On fasting days or if headaches present	Essential for Week 1 adaptation
Omega-3 (fish oil, EPA/DHA)	1–2 g EPA+DHA	With a meal	Anti-inflammatory, supports insulin sensitivity

Tier 2 — Gut and Metabolic Support (Optional Add-Ons)

Supplement	Dose	Timing	Evidence
Multi-strain probiotic (Lactobacillus + Bifidobacterium)	Per product label	Morning, with or without food	Meta-analyses: modest HbA1c, fasting glucose, BP improvements in T2D
Vitamin D3 + K2	2,000–4,000 IU D3 + 100 mcg K2	With a fat-containing meal	Very common UK deficiency; supports insulin sensitivity
Glycine	3 g	Before bed	Emerging evidence for subjective sleep depth

Tier 3 — Glucose Support (Clinician Supervision Only)

Supplement	Notes
Berberine	HbA1c reductions comparable to metformin in some trials; interacts with medications; GI side effects; use only under clinician guidance
Inositol	Some evidence in insulin resistance and PCOS; generally well tolerated
Alpha-lipoic acid	Antioxidant; some evidence for insulin sensitivity; check interactions

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PART FIVE: CHEAT SHEETS

CHEAT SHEET 1 — DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLES

Print this. Stick it on the fridge.

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│           DAILY METABOLIC RESET CHECKLIST                 │
│                                                           │
│  EATING                                                   │
│  [ ] Protein-first meal — 25–35 g per sitting            │
│  [ ] Non-starchy vegetables with every meal              │
│  [ ] No sugary drinks today                              │
│  [ ] No seed oils used in cooking                        │
│  [ ] One fermented food                                   │
│  [ ] One prebiotic food (garlic, onion, leeks)           │
│                                                           │
│  FASTING                                                  │
│  [ ] 12–16 hour overnight fast maintained                │
│  [ ] Fasting window hydrated: water, tea, coffee         │
│  [ ] Electrolytes if on fast day                         │
│                                                           │
│  MOVEMENT                                                 │
│  [ ] 10-minute walk after biggest meal                   │
│  [ ] Zone 2 or strength session (as per plan)            │
│                                                           │
│  SLEEP                                                    │
│  [ ] Same bedtime as yesterday                           │
│  [ ] Caffeine cut by 2–3 pm                              │
│  [ ] Phone away 30 min before bed                        │
│  [ ] Magnesium glycinate taken if using                  │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

CHEAT SHEET 2 — FASTING WINDOWS AT A GLANCE

```
Track A (Beginner / Busy)
──────────────────────────

  8pm ──────────── fast ──────────── 8am
         12 hours overnight fast
         (Minimum for the reset)

  8pm ──────────── fast ──────────── 10am
         14 hours (progress to this by Week 2)

Track B (Advanced — only when comfortable)
──────────────────────────────────────────

  8pm ──────────── fast ──────────── 12pm
         16 hours (16:8)

  Monday 8pm ───── fast ───── Tuesday 8pm
         24-hour dinner-to-dinner fast
         (Once per week, medically cleared only)

During fasting windows, you may have:
✓ Water              ✓ Black coffee
✓ Plain tea          ✓ Bone broth
✓ Electrolytes       ✗ Food
                     ✗ Artificial sweeteners
                     ✗ Milk / cream
```

CHEAT SHEET 3 — APPROVED FATS (QUICK REFERENCE)

```
COOK WITH                    DRESS / FINISH WITH
──────────────────────       ──────────────────────
✓ Coconut oil (virgin)        ✓ Extra-virgin olive oil
✓ Ghee                        ✓ Avocado oil
✓ Grass-fed butter            ✓ Whole avocado
✓ Beef tallow                 ✓ Olives

DO NOT USE
──────────────────────────────────────────────────
✗ Rapeseed oil / canola oil
✗ Sunflower oil
✗ Soybean oil
✗ Corn oil
✗ Cottonseed oil
✗ Generic "vegetable oil"
✗ Margarine or "spreads"
```

CHEAT SHEET 4 — ZONE 2 HEART RATE GUIDE

```
YOUR AGE    TARGET ZONE 2 RANGE     TALK TEST CHECK
────────    ───────────────────     ───────────────────────
35          108–126 bpm             Can speak in full sentences
40          105–122 bpm             Slight breathiness is fine
45          101–118 bpm             Cannot sing a song easily
50          98–114 bpm              Should feel "comfortably hard"
55          94–110 bpm              If beta-blockers: ignore HR
60          91–106 bpm              Use talk test / RPE only

NOTE: These are approximate. If on heart medication, use RPE:
"This feels like a 3–4 out of 10 effort — I could keep this up
for 30–45 minutes."
```

CHEAT SHEET 5 — RAPID RESET (AFTER A SLIP)

```
OPTION A — Conservative Rapid Reset
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────

1. Return to protein-first meals at the very next meal
2. No grazing. No snacking.
3. Remove all sugar and refined carbs for 48 hours
4. Hydrate well — aim for 2–3 litres of water today
5. 14–16-hour overnight fast if tolerated
6. Walk 10 minutes after every meal today

OPTION B — Advanced Rapid Reset (medically cleared only)
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────

1. Finish your last off-plan meal
2. Begin a 20–24-hour dinner-to-dinner fast
3. Water, black coffee, plain tea, bone broth, electrolytes
4. No intense exercise on fast day — gentle walk only
5. Break fast with a protein-first meal (eggs, fish, or meat)
   NOT with a sugar-heavy reward

KEY RULE: One slip does not erase 10 days of progress.
Return at the next meal, not next Monday.
```

PART SIX: 21-DAY HABIT TRACKER

Print this. Tick each box daily.

WEEK 1 TRACKER (Days 1–7)

Habit	D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6	D7
Protein-first plate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No sugary drinks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No seed oils	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fermented food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prebiotic food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12+ hr overnight fast	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-meal walk	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zone 2 or strength	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7–8 hrs sleep	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Magnesium taken	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

WEEK 2 TRACKER (Days 8–14)

Habit	D8	D9	D10	D11	D12	D13	D14
Protein-first plate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No sugary drinks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No seed oils	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fermented food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prebiotic food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fasting window met	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-meal walk	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zone 2 or strength	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7–8 hrs sleep	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Electrolytes on fast day	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

WEEK 3 TRACKER (Days 15–21)

Habit	D15	D16	D17	D18	D19	D20	D21
Protein-first plate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No sugary drinks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No seed oils	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fermented food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fasting window met	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-meal walk	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zone 2 or strength	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7–8 hrs sleep	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Breathwork done	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART SEVEN: WEEKLY REFLECTION TEMPLATES

WEEK 1 REFLECTION (Complete on Day 7)

Numbers:

- Weight today: _____ | Change from Day 1: _____
- Waist today: _____ | Change from Day 1: _____
- BP today (if available): _____

Ratings (1–10):

- Energy: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)
- Sleep quality: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)

- Digestion / bloating: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)
- Cravings: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)

Reflection questions:

1. Which meals worked best this week?
2. What was the hardest part?
3. Did any foods cause noticeable bloating, energy dips, or cravings?
4. Did the fasting window feel manageable?
5. What will I do differently in Week 2?

WEEK 2 REFLECTION (Complete on Day 14)

Numbers:

- Weight today: _____ | Total change: _____
- Waist today: _____ | Total change: _____

Ratings (1–10):

- Energy: _____ | Sleep: _____ | Digestion: _____ | Cravings: _____

Reflection questions:

1. Is energy more stable between meals than Week 1?
2. Have cravings reduced?
3. Which movement sessions happened? Which were skipped?
4. Any foods I tried to reintroduce that caused a reaction?
5. What is my goal for Week 3?

WEEK 3 REFLECTION (Complete on Day 21)

Numbers:

- Weight today: _____ | 21-day total change: _____
- Waist today: _____ | 21-day total change: _____

- BP today: _____
- Any glucose or HbA1c recheck available: _____

Ratings (1–10):

- Energy: _____ | Sleep: _____ | Digestion: _____ | Cravings: _____

21-Day Summary:

1. What is the most important habit I built?
2. What felt most impactful on energy or digestion?
3. What will I carry forward into the next 90 days?
4. Will I repeat the reset monthly, quarterly, or continue into a longer phase?
5. What clinician appointments do I need to book? (HbA1c recheck at 3 months, medication review)

PART EIGHT: PRINTABLE SHOPPING LIST

PROTEINS

- [ ] Eggs (dozen)
- [ ] Wild-caught salmon (fresh or frozen)
- [ ] Tinned sardines or mackerel (in olive oil or brine)
- [ ] Tinned tuna (in water or olive oil)
- [ ] Chicken thighs or breasts
- [ ] Grass-fed beef mince (500g–1kg)
- [ ] Lamb mince or chops
- [ ] Steak (any cut you prefer)
- [ ] Full-fat Greek yogurt (Fage Total 5% or 0% if preferred)
- [ ] Thick, high-protein natural yogurt

- [ ] Cottage cheese

VEGETABLES

- [ ] Spinach (bag or bunch)
- [ ] Rocket / salad leaves
- [ ] Broccoli
- [ ] Cauliflower
- [ ] Courgettes
- [ ] Mushrooms
- [ ] Peppers (mixed)
- [ ] Green beans
- [ ] Asparagus
- [ ] Carrots
- [ ] Avocados (4–6)
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes
- [ ] Cucumber
- [ ] Cabbage
- [ ] Garlic (bulb)
- [ ] Onions
- [ ] Leeks

HEALTHY FATS

- [ ] Extra-virgin olive oil (good quality)
- [ ] Avocado oil
- [ ] Coconut oil (virgin)
- [ ] Ghee or butter (grass-fed)
- [ ] Olives (jar)

- [ ] Mixed nuts (walnuts, almonds, macadamia)

LOW-GI CARBS (OPTIONAL / SMALL PORTIONS)

- [ ] Tinned lentils or dried lentils
- [ ] Tinned chickpeas
- [ ] Tinned black beans
- [ ] Berries (fresh or frozen)
- [ ] Sweet potato (one or two)
- [ ] Genuine sourdough loaf (if needed — use sparingly)

GUT SUPPORT

- [ ] Live sauerkraut (refrigerated, not pasteurised)
- [ ] Kimchi (if tolerated)
- [ ] Kefir (full fat, unsweetened — if dairy tolerated)

PANTRY AND SUPPLEMENTS

- [ ] Bone broth (Freja, Borough Broth, or similar)
- [ ] Electrolyte sachets (LMNT or similar — sodium, potassium, magnesium)
- [ ] Magnesium glycinate capsules
- [ ] Clean whey isolate (optional protein powder — no maltodextrin)
- [ ] Sea salt or Himalayan salt
- [ ] Apple cider vinegar (optional — some evidence for post-meal glucose blunting)

PART NINE: FAQ / EPQ (HONEST ANSWERS)

Q1: What if I fall off the wagon completely?

Return at the very next meal. Not next Monday. Not tomorrow. The next meal.

One off-plan day does not undo 10 days of metabolic progress. The only thing that undoes progress is a series of off-plan days that drift into an off-plan week. Use Cheat Sheet 5 (Rapid Reset) if you went significantly off track.

Q2: What if I miss a day entirely?

Resume where you left off. Think of this as 21 training sessions, not 21 perfect days. Missing one session means you continue with the next one.

Q3: What if I ate badly at a work event or social occasion?

This is normal life. Use Option A from the Rapid Reset cheat sheet. Return to protein-first meals, no snacking, 14–16-hour overnight fast, drink plenty of water, and walk after your next meal. You'll be back on track within 24–48 hours.

Q4: What if the fasting window is too hard?

Shorten it. A consistent 12-hour overnight fast done every day is more powerful than forcing 16:8 twice a week and abandoning it. Build up gradually — even 30 minutes of pushing breakfast later every week adds up.

Q5: I am hungry all the time. What do I do?

First: are you eating enough protein? Many people discover they are eating far less protein than they think. Check whether you are genuinely hitting 25–35 g per meal.

Second: are your meals high enough in fat? Low-fat and low-carb together creates hunger. This guide uses healthy fats precisely to maintain satiety.

Q6: What if I feel dizzy, shaky, or unwell while fasting?

Stop the fast. Break it with food. Assess whether you are hydrating enough and using electrolytes. If symptoms are severe, recur frequently, or you are on diabetes or blood pressure medication — speak to your clinician before continuing.

Q7: What if my energy crashes in Week 1?

Days 3–5 are the peak adaptation period. This is the body shifting from glucose-dominant to fat-adapted metabolism. It is temporary. Electrolytes, adequate hydration, and enough dietary fat all reduce this window. Most people emerge from it by days 6–8 with noticeably better energy.

Q8: I'm on medication for diabetes or blood pressure. Can I do this?

Yes, but with medical supervision. Bring the summary of this guide to your clinician and tell them you are reducing carbohydrates, introducing fasting, and increasing activity. Ask them to monitor your medication needs — blood sugar and blood pressure improvements may mean your doses need to come down. Do not adjust medication independently.

Q9: Can I do this guide if I have type 1 diabetes?

Not independently. This guide is designed for people with insulin resistance, pre-diabetes, and type 2 diabetes. Type 1 diabetes requires specialist supervision for any

fasting or carbohydrate-restriction protocol.

Q10: What if I have no energy for exercise in Week 1?

Begin with Level 1 only: two short walks per day. Do not add strength work in the first 5 days if energy is low. As adaptation completes (usually days 6–10), energy typically rebounds and training feels more accessible.

Q11: How do I do the advanced rapid reset fast safely?

See Cheat Sheet 5. The key rules: stay hydrated, use electrolytes, no intense exercise on fast day, break the fast with a protein-first meal not a high-sugar meal. If you feel genuinely unwell at any point, break the fast and eat. Safety always overrides protocol.

Q12: When will I actually see HbA1c improve?

HbA1c reflects approximately three months of blood sugar history. It will not move meaningfully in 21 days. Your goal for Day 21 is to have your fasting glucose, blood pressure, energy, digestion, and weight all moving in the right direction — those changes are measurable now. Recheck HbA1c at 3 months with your clinician.

Q13: Can I use this guide without ever fasting?

Yes. The nutritional and movement pillars alone produce significant metabolic benefit. Fasting is the accelerant, not the foundation. If fasting is not appropriate for you medically or practically, focus on the plate, protein, elimination, gut support, Zone 2 walking, and sleep — that is already a substantial intervention.

PART TEN: HOW TO USE REMINDERS AND STAY ON TRACK

Phone-Based Reminder Setup

Daily reminders to set:

Reminder	Time	Label
Fasting start reminder	Evening (after dinner)	“Fasting window begins now”
Morning hydration	Wake time	“Water + electrolytes first”
Post-meal walk	30 min after lunch	“10-min walk — blood sugar reset”
Post-dinner walk	30 min after dinner	“Evening walk — metabolism on”
Magnesium / supplements	1.5 hrs before bed	“Sleep stack time”
Bedtime	Your chosen time	“Wind down — phone away”

How to set:

- iPhone: Clock app → Alarm → Label it as above
- Android: Google Clock or Samsung Clock — same method
- Or use a habit tracker app: Habitica, Streaks (iOS), Loop Habit Tracker (Android), or Notion daily template

21-Day Calendar Template

Use a simple physical calendar or the template below. Mark each completed day.

```
WEEK 1
Mon  Tue  Wed  Thu  Fri  Sat  Sun
 D1   D2   D3   D4   D5   D6   D7
 [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]

WEEK 2
Mon  Tue  Wed  Thu  Fri  Sat  Sun
 D8   D9  D10  D11  D12  D13  D14
 [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]

WEEK 3
Mon  Tue  Wed  Thu  Fri  Sat  Sun
D15  D16  D17  D18  D19  D20  D21
 [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]
```

Each ticked box is a completed day. Your only goal: more ticks than spaces.

PART ELEVEN: WHAT TO DO NEXT — THE 90-DAY PLAN

Day 21 is the launch pad.

The science is consistent: habits take a mean of 66 days to become automatic (Lally, European Journal of Social Psychology, 2010). At Day 21 you are approximately one-third of the way to automatic. The next 45 days are the most important.

Option 1 — Monthly Tune-Up Model

- Follow the full 21 days.
- Then maintain the core habits (protein-first, no seed oils, fasting window, daily movement, sleep) without strict day-by-day rules.
- Repeat Days 1–7 as a “reset week” at the start of each month.
- This works well for people who do well with a structured anchor but prefer flexibility between resets.

Option 2 — Continue Strict

- Repeat the full 21-day programme immediately.
- By Day 42, habits are significantly more embedded.
- Use the Week 3 reflection to slightly increase fasting intensity or movement volume in the second cycle.

Option 3 — Graduate to 90-Day Lifestyle Integration

- Keep the PERC principles as your permanent framework.
- Add more food variety as you understand your personal tolerance.
- Reintroduce foods carefully one at a time (dairy, gluten, legumes) and note responses.
- Commit to a 3-month HbA1c recheck and a medication review with your clinician.

Your Day 22 Checklist

- [ ] Book a clinician appointment for 3-month HbA1c and blood pressure review
- [ ] Choose your next-phase model (above)
- [ ] Set your ongoing weekly movement target (minimum 150 minutes)
- [ ] Keep the fasting window as your daily default
- [ ] Continue fermented and prebiotic foods daily
- [ ] Re-read the FAQ if doubts or questions arise

A FINAL NOTE

This guide is built on evidence from leading medical journals and clinical frameworks focusing on fasting, insulin regulation, protein for longevity, diabetes reversal, low-carbohydrate nutrition, and metabolic conditioning. References available on request.

21 days is a biologically real, clinically meaningful head-start — not a cure. The data is consistent: rapid reduction in carbohydrates and insulin load, combined with

adequate protein, consistent movement, better sleep, and gut support, can move every measurable metabolic marker in the right direction within three weeks.

Except HbA1c. That takes 90 days. That is what Day 22 is for.

This guide is for informational purposes only. It is not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Always consult a qualified healthcare provider before making changes to your diet, exercise programme, or medication.

© Why Your Weight Isn't Shifting — 21-Day Metabolic Reset Guide , handful of spinach, half an avocado | | Lunch | Tinned wild-caught sardines or tuna with salad (rocket, cucumber, cherry tomatoes), drizzled with olive oil and lemon | | Dinner | Grass-fed beef mince stir-fried in coconut oil with broccoli, courgette, garlic, and mushrooms | | Snack (if needed) | Full-fat Greek yogurt with a handful of blueberries |

DAY 2

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	2 poached eggs on a bed of wilted spinach, cooked in butter
Lunch	Leftover beef mince with salad leaves and olive oil
Dinner	Wild-caught salmon fillet baked or pan-fried in coconut oil, with roasted asparagus and cauliflower
Snack (if needed)	Small handful of mixed nuts (walnuts, almonds)

DAY 3

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	Full-fat skyr with berries and a tablespoon of ground flaxseed
Lunch	Chicken thigh (roasted or grilled), green salad, half avocado, olive oil dressing
Dinner	Lamb mince with courgette noodles (spiralised or ribboned with a peeler), garlic, and fresh herbs
Snack (if needed)	Cottage cheese with cucumber slices

DAY 4

Meal	What to eat
Breakfast	3-egg omelette with mushrooms, onions, and a little butter
Lunch	Tinned mackerel (in olive oil or brine) with roasted peppers and a small portion of lentils
Dinner	Grass-fed steak (any cut) cooked in butter or tallow, with green beans and a side salad
Snack (if needed)	Greek yogurt

7-Day Metabolic Reset Meal Plan

This meal plan is designed around established principles of intermittent fasting (no snacking) and healthy low-carbohydrate eating. All meals are low-carb, high in healthy fats, and nutrient-dense.

Fasting Schedule: Aim for a 16:8 fasting window. For example, eat your first meal at 12:00 PM and your last meal by 8:00 PM. Drink water, black coffee, or herbal tea outside this window.

Day	Lunch (12:00 PM)	Dinner (7:00 PM)
1	**Large Tuna & Avocado Salad:** Mixed greens, cucumber, cherry tomatoes, one whole avocado, and a tin of wild-caught tuna in olive oil.	**Beef & Broccoli Stir-fry:** Grass-fed beef mince stir-fried in coconut oil with broccoli florets, garlic, and ginger.
2	**Leftover Beef & Broccoli Stir-fry** with a side of kimchi for gut health.	**Baked Salmon with Asparagus:** Wild-caught salmon fillet baked with a drizzle of olive oil, served with roasted asparagus.
3	**Mushroom & Spinach Omelette:** 3-egg omelette cooked in butter with mushrooms, a large handful of spinach, and a sprinkle of cheese.	**Roasted Chicken Thighs:** Two chicken thighs roasted with peppers and onions, served with a side of cauliflower mash.
4	**Grilled Halloumi Salad:** Mixed salad leaves with grilled halloumi, walnuts, and an olive oil vinaigrette.	**Lamb Chops with Greens:** Lamb chops pan-fried in ghee, served with steamed green beans and kale.
5	**"No-Bread" Tuna Melt:** Tinned tuna mixed with avocado oil mayonnaise and cheese, grilled on top of large mushroom caps.	**Keto Butter Chicken:** Cubed chicken in a creamy, low-carb butter chicken sauce, served with cauliflower rice.
6	**Supermarket Shortcut:** Rotisserie chicken from a local supermarket (e.g., M&S, Tesco) with a large pre-washed bag of salad.	**Steak Night:** Grass-fed steak cooked in butter, served with a side of creamed spinach.
7	**Leftover Steak & Creamed Spinach.**	**Hearty Bone Broth Soup:** A larg### 7-Day Metabolic Reset Meal Plan

This meal plan is designed around established principles of intermittent fasting (no snacking) and healthy low-carbohydrate eating. All meals are low-carb, high in healthy fats, and nutrient-dense.

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2	**Leftover Beef & Broccoli Stir-fry** with a side of kimchi for gut health.	**Baked Salmon with Asparagus:** Wild-caught salmon fillet baked with a drizzle of olive oil, served with roasted asparagus.
3	**Mushroom & Spinach Omelette:** 3-egg omelette cooked in butter with mushrooms, a large handful of spinach, and a sprinkle of cheese.	**Roasted Chicken Thighs:** Two chicken thighs roasted with peppers and onions, served with a side of cauliflower mash.
4	**Grilled Halloumi Salad:** Mixed salad leaves with grilled halloumi, walnuts, and an olive oil vinaigrette.	**Lamb Chops with Greens:** Lamb chops pan-fried in ghee, served with steamed green beans and kale.
5	**"No-Bread" Tuna Melt:** Tinned tuna mixed with avocado oil mayonnaise and cheese, grilled on top of large mushroom caps.	**Keto Butter Chicken:** Cubed chicken in a creamy, low-carb butter chicken sauce, served with cauliflower rice.
6	**Supermarket Shortcut:** Rotisserie chicken from a local supermarket (e.g., M&S, Tesco) with a large pre-washed bag of salad.	**Steak Night:** Grass-fed steak cooked in butter, served with a side of creamed spinach.
7	**Leftover Steak & Creamed Spinach.**	**Hearty Bone Broth Soup:** A large bowl of bone broth with shredded chicken and plenty of non-starchy vegetables.

Supermarket-Ready Meal Shortcuts

For very busy days when cooking is not possible:

- **Major supermarkets (e.g., Sainsbury's, Tesco, M&S):** Pre-cooked rotisserie chicken + bagged salad + avocado + olive oil = full reset meal in 3 minutes
- **Tinned sardines or mackerel + salad bag + olive oil drizzle** = complete protein-first plate, no cooking required

- **Full-fat Greek yogurt + berries + nuts** = fast breakfast with 18–25 g protein (for non-fasting days)
- **Hard-boiled eggs (pre-pack) + cucumber + olives** = emergency snack or light meal
- **Major supermarkets' pre-prepared salmon portions** + microwaveable broccoli = 10-minute dinner
- **Bone broth pouches** (Freja, Borough Broth, Heston Blumenthal range) — for fast days or gut-support days

Always check labels for: added sugars, seed oils (rapeseed, sunflower, vegetable oil), maltodextrin, and processed additives.

PART FOUR: SUPPLEMENT STACK

Supplements support but do not replace the food, fasting, sleep, and movement plan.

Tier 1 — Sleep and Basic Support (Gentle, Evidence-Based)

Supplement	Dose	Timing	Evidence
Magnesium glycinate or bisglycinate	200–400 mg elemental	1–2 hours before bed	RCTs show reduced sleep latency, improved sleep quality, lower cortisol
Electrolytes (sodium, potassium, magnesium)	Per sachet guidance	On fasting days or if headaches present	Essential for Week 1 adaptation
Omega-3 (fish oil, EPA/DHA)	1–2 g EPA+DHA	With a meal	Anti-inflammatory, supports insulin sensitivity

Tier 2 — Gut and Metabolic Support (Optional Add-Ons)

Supplement	Dose	Timing	Evidence
Multi-strain probiotic (Lactobacillus + Bifidobacterium)	Per product label	Morning, with or without food	Meta-analyses: modest HbA1c, fasting glucose, BP improvements in T2D
Vitamin D3 + K2	2,000–4,000 IU D3 + 100 mcg K2	With a fat-containing meal	Very common UK deficiency; supports insulin sensitivity
Glycine	3 g	Before bed	Emerging evidence for subjective sleep depth

Tier 3 — Glucose Support (Clinician Supervision Only)

Supplement	Notes
Berberine	HbA1c reductions comparable to metformin in some trials; interacts with medications; GI side effects; use only under clinician guidance
Inositol	Some evidence in insulin resistance and PCOS; generally well tolerated
Alpha-lipoic acid	Antioxidant; some evidence for insulin sensitivity; check interactions

---

PART FIVE: CHEAT SHEETS

CHEAT SHEET 1 — DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLES

Print this. Stick it on the fridge.

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│           DAILY METABOLIC RESET CHECKLIST                 │
│                                                           │
│  EATING                                                   │
│  [ ] Protein-first meal — 25–35 g per sitting            │
│  [ ] Non-starchy vegetables with every meal              │
│  [ ] No sugary drinks today                              │
│  [ ] No seed oils used in cooking                        │
│  [ ] One fermented food                                   │
│  [ ] One prebiotic food (garlic, onion, leeks)           │
│                                                           │
│  FASTING                                                  │
│  [ ] 12–16 hour overnight fast maintained                │
│  [ ] Fasting window hydrated: water, tea, coffee         │
│  [ ] Electrolytes if on fast day                         │
│                                                           │
│  MOVEMENT                                                 │
│  [ ] 10-minute walk after biggest meal                   │
│  [ ] Zone 2 or strength session (as per plan)            │
│                                                           │
│  SLEEP                                                    │
│  [ ] Same bedtime as yesterday                           │
│  [ ] Caffeine cut by 2–3 pm                              │
│  [ ] Phone away 30 min before bed                        │
│  [ ] Magnesium glycinate taken if using                  │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

CHEAT SHEET 2 — FASTING WINDOWS AT A GLANCE

```
Track A (Beginner / Busy)
──────────────────────────

  8pm ──────────── fast ──────────── 8am
         12 hours overnight fast
         (Minimum for the reset)

  8pm ──────────── fast ──────────── 10am
         14 hours (progress to this by Week 2)

Track B (Advanced — only when comfortable)
──────────────────────────────────────────

  8pm ──────────── fast ──────────── 12pm
         16 hours (16:8)

  Monday 8pm ────── fast ────── Tuesday 8pm
         24-hour dinner-to-dinner fast
         (Once per week, medically cleared only)

During fasting windows, you may have:
✓ Water              ✓ Black coffee
✓ Plain tea          ✓ Bone broth
✓ Electrolytes       ✗ Food
                     ✗ Artificial sweeteners
                     ✗ Milk / cream
```

CHEAT SHEET 3 — APPROVED FATS (QUICK REFERENCE)

```
COOK WITH                    DRESS / FINISH WITH
──────────────────────       ──────────────────────
✓ Coconut oil (virgin)       ✓ Extra-virgin olive oil
✓ Ghee                       ✓ Avocado oil
✓ Grass-fed butter           ✓ Whole avocado
✓ Beef tallow                ✓ Olives

DO NOT USE
──────────────────────────────────────────────────
✗ Rapeseed oil / canola oil
✗ Sunflower oil
✗ Soybean oil
✗ Corn oil
✗ Cottonseed oil
✗ Generic "vegetable oil"
✗ Margarine or "spreads"
```

CHEAT SHEET 4 — ZONE 2 HEART RATE GUIDE

```
YOUR AGE    TARGET ZONE 2 RANGE     TALK TEST CHECK
────────    ───────────────────     ──────────────────────
35          108–126 bpm             Can speak in full sentences
40          105–122 bpm             Slight breathiness is fine
45          101–118 bpm             Cannot sing a song easily
50          98–114 bpm              Should feel "comfortably hard"
55          94–110 bpm              If beta-blockers: ignore HR
60          91–106 bpm              Use talk test / RPE only

NOTE: These are approximate. If on heart medication, use RPE:
"This feels like a 3–4 out of 10 effort — I could keep this up
for 30–45 minutes."
```

CHEAT SHEET 5 — RAPID RESET (AFTER A SLIP)

```
OPTION A — Conservative Rapid Reset
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────

1. Return to protein-first meals at the very next meal
2. No grazing. No snacking.
3. Remove all sugar and refined carbs for 48 hours
4. Hydrate well — aim for 2–3 litres of water today
5. 14–16-hour overnight fast if tolerated
6. Walk 10 minutes after every meal today

OPTION B — Advanced Rapid Reset (medically cleared only)
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────

1. Finish your last off-plan meal
2. Begin a 20–24-hour dinner-to-dinner fast
3. Water, black coffee, plain tea, bone broth, electrolytes
4. No intense exercise on fast day — gentle walk only
5. Break fast with a protein-first meal (eggs, fish, or meat)
   NOT with a sugar-heavy reward

KEY RULE: One slip does not erase 10 days of progress.
Return at the next meal, not next Monday.
```

PART SIX: 21-DAY HABIT TRACKER

Print this. Tick each box daily.

WEEK 1 TRACKER (Days 1–7)

Habit	D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6	D7
Protein-first plate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No sugary drinks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No seed oils	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fermented food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prebiotic food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12+ hr overnight fast	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-meal walk	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zone 2 or strength	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7–8 hrs sleep	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Magnesium taken	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

WEEK 2 TRACKER (Days 8–14)

Habit	D8	D9	D10	D11	D12	D13	D14
Protein-first plate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No sugary drinks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No seed oils	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fermented food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prebiotic food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fasting window met	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-meal walk	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zone 2 or strength	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7–8 hrs sleep	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Electrolytes on fast day	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

WEEK 3 TRACKER (Days 15–21)

Habit	D15	D16	D17	D18	D19	D20	D21
Protein-first plate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No sugary drinks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No seed oils	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fermented food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fasting window met	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-meal walk	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zone 2 or strength	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7–8 hrs sleep	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Breathwork done	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART SEVEN: WEEKLY REFLECTION TEMPLATES

WEEK 1 REFLECTION (Complete on Day 7)

Numbers:

- Weight today: _____ | Change from Day 1: _____
- Waist today: _____ | Change from Day 1: _____
- BP today (if available): _____

Ratings (1–10):

- Energy: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)
- Sleep quality: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)
- Digestion / bloating: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)
- Cravings: _____ (was _____ on Day 1)

Reflection questions:

1. Which meals worked best this week?
2. What was the hardest part?
3. Did any foods cause noticeable bloating, energy dips, or cravings?
4. Did the fasting window feel manageable?
5. What will I do differently in Week 2?

WEEK 2 REFLECTION (Complete on Day 14)

Numbers:

- Weight today: _____ | Total change: _____
- Waist today: _____ | Total change: _____

Ratings (1–10):

- Energy: _____ | Sleep: _____ | Digestion: _____ | Cravings: _____

Reflection questions:

1. Is energy more stable between meals than Week 1?
2. Have cravings reduced?
3. Which movement sessions happened? Which were skipped?
4. Any foods I tried to reintroduce that caused a reaction?
5. What is my goal for Week 3?

WEEK 3 REFLECTION (Complete on Day 21)

Numbers:

- Weight today: _____ | 21-day total change: _____
- Waist today: _____ | 21-day total change: _____
- BP today: _____
- Any glucose or HbA1c recheck available: _____

Ratings (1–10):

- Energy: _____ | Sleep: _____ | Digestion: _____ | Cravings: _____

21-Day Summary:

1. What is the most important habit I built?
2. What felt most impactful on energy or digestion?
3. What will I carry forward into the next 90 days?
4. Will I repeat the reset monthly, quarterly, or continue into a longer phase?
5. What clinician appointments do I need to book? (HbA1c recheck at 3 months, medication review)

PART EIGHT: PRINTABLE SHOPPING LIST

PROTEINS

- [ ] Eggs (dozen)
- [ ] Wild-caught salmon (fresh or frozen)
- [ ] Tinned sardines or mackerel (in olive oil or brine)
- [ ] Tinned tuna (in water or olive oil)
- [ ] Chicken thighs or breasts
- [ ] Grass-fed beef mince (500g–1kg)
- [ ] Lamb mince or chops
- [ ] Steak (any cut you prefer)
- [ ] Full-fat Greek yogurt (Fage Total 5% or 0% if preferred)
- [ ] Thick, high-protein natural yogurt
- [ ] Cottage cheese

VEGETABLES

- [ ] Spinach (bag or bunch)
- [ ] Rocket / salad leaves
- [ ] Broccoli
- [ ] Cauliflower
- [ ] Courgettes
- [ ] Mushrooms
- [ ] Peppers (mixed)
- [ ] Green beans
- [ ] Asparagus
- [ ] Carrots
- [ ] Avocados (4–6)
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes
- [ ] Cucumber
- [ ] Cabbage
- [ ] Garlic (bulb)
- [ ] Onions
- [ ] Leeks

HEALTHY FATS

- [ ] Extra-virgin olive oil (good quality)
- [ ] Avocado oil
- [ ] Coconut oil (virgin)
- [ ] Ghee or butter (grass-fed)
- [ ] Olives (jar)
- [ ] Mixed nuts (walnuts, almonds, macadamia)

LOW-GI CARBS (OPTIONAL / SMALL PORTIONS)

- [ ] Tinned lentils or dried lentils
- [ ] Tinned chickpeas
- [ ] Tinned black beans
- [ ] Berries (fresh or frozen)
- [ ] Sweet potato (one or two)
- [ ] Genuine sourdough loaf (if needed — use sparingly)

GUT SUPPORT

- [ ] Live sauerkraut (refrigerated, not pasteurised)
- [ ] Kimchi (if tolerated)
- [ ] Kefir (full fat, unsweetened — if dairy tolerated)

PANTRY AND SUPPLEMENTS

- [ ] Bone broth (Freja, Borough Broth, or similar)
- [ ] Electrolyte sachets (LMNT or similar — sodium, potassium, magnesium)
- [ ] Magnesium glycinate capsules
- [ ] Clean whey isolate (optional protein powder — no maltodextrin)
- [ ] Sea salt or Himalayan salt
- [ ] Apple cider vinegar (optional — some evidence for post-meal glucose blunting)

PART NINE: FAQ / EPQ (HONEST ANSWERS)

Q1: What if I fall off the wagon completely?

Return at the very next meal. Not next Monday. Not tomorrow. The next meal.

One off-plan day does not undo 10 days of metabolic progress. The only thing that undoes progress is a series of off-plan days that drift into an off-plan week. Use Cheat Sheet 5 (Rapid Reset) if you went significantly off track.

Q2: What if I miss a day entirely?

Resume where you left off. Think of this as 21 training sessions, not 21 perfect days. Missing one session means you continue with the next one.

Q3: What if I ate badly at a work event or social occasion?

This is normal life. Use Option A from the Rapid Reset cheat sheet. Return to protein-first meals, no snacking, 14–16-hour overnight fast, drink plenty of water, and walk after your next meal. You'll be back on track within 24–48 hours.

Q4: What if the fasting window is too hard?

Shorten it. A consistent 12-hour overnight fast done every day is more powerful than forcing 16:8 twice a week and abandoning it. Build up gradually — even 30 minutes of pushing breakfast later every week adds up.

Q5: I am hungry all the time. What do I do?

First: are you eating enough protein? Many people discover they are eating far less protein than they think. Check whether you are genuinely hitting 25–35 g per meal.

Second: are your meals high enough in fat? Low-fat and low-carb together creates hunger. This guide uses healthy fats precisely to maintain satiety.

Q6: What if I feel dizzy, shaky, or unwell while fasting?

Stop the fast. Break it with food. Assess whether you are hydrating enough and using electrolytes. If symptoms are severe, recur frequently, or you are on diabetes or blood pressure medication — speak to your clinician before continuing.

Q7: What if my energy crashes in Week 1?

Days 3–5 are the peak adaptation period. This is the body shifting from glucose-dominant to fat-adapted metabolism. It is temporary. Electrolytes, adequate hydration, and enough dietary fat all reduce this window. Most people emerge from it by days 6–8 with noticeably better energy.

Q8: I'm on medication for diabetes or blood pressure. Can I do this?

Yes, but with medical supervision. Bring the summary of this guide to your clinician and tell them you are reducing carbohydrates, introducing fasting, and increasing activity. Ask them to monitor your medication needs — blood sugar and blood pressure improvements may mean your doses need to come down. Do not adjust medication independently.

Q9: Can I do this guide if I have type 1 diabetes?

Not independently. This guide is designed for people with insulin resistance, pre-diabetes, and type 2 diabetes. Type 1 diabetes requires specialist supervision for any fasting or carbohydrate-restriction protocol.

Q10: What if I have no energy for exercise in Week 1?

Begin with Level 1 only: two short walks per day. Do not add strength work in the first 5 days if energy is low. As adaptation completes (usually days 6–10), energy typically rebounds and training feels more accessible.

Q11: How do I do the advanced rapid reset fast safely?

See Cheat Sheet 5. The key rules: stay hydrated, use electrolytes, no intense exercise on fast day, break the fast with a protein-first meal not a high-sugar meal. If you feel genuinely unwell at any point, break the fast and eat. Safety always overrides protocol.

Q12: When will I actually see HbA1c improve?

HbA1c reflects approximately three months of blood sugar history. It will not move meaningfully in 21 days. Your goal for Day 21 is to have your fasting glucose, blood pressure, energy, digestion, and weight all moving in the right direction — those changes are measurable now. Recheck HbA1c at 3 months with your clinician.

Q13: Can I use this guide without ever fasting?

Yes. The nutritional and movement pillars alone produce significant metabolic benefit. Fasting is the accelerant, not the foundation. If fasting is not appropriate for you medically or practically, focus on the plate, protein, elimination, gut support, Zone 2 walking, and sleep — that is already a substantial intervention.

PART TEN: HOW TO USE REMINDERS AND STAY ON TRACK

Phone-Based Reminder Setup

Daily reminders to set:

Reminder	Time	Label
Fasting start reminder	Evening (after dinner)	“Fasting window begins now”
Morning hydration	Wake time	“Water + electrolytes first”
Post-meal walk	30 min after lunch	“10-min walk — blood sugar reset”
Post-dinner walk	30 min after dinner	“Evening walk — metabolism on”
Magnesium / supplements	1.5 hrs before bed	“Sleep stack time”
Bedtime	Your chosen time	“Wind down — phone away”

How to set:

- iPhone: Clock app → Alarm → Label it as above
- Android: Google Clock or Samsung Clock — same method
- Or use a habit tracker app: Habitica, Streaks (iOS), Loop Habit Tracker (Android), or Notion daily template

21-Day Calendar Template

Use a simple physical calendar or the template below. Mark each completed day.

```
WEEK 1
Mon  Tue  Wed  Thu  Fri  Sat  Sun
 D1   D2   D3   D4   D5   D6   D7
 [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]

WEEK 2
Mon  Tue  Wed  Thu  Fri  Sat  Sun
 D8   D9  D10  D11  D12  D13  D14
 [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]

WEEK 3
Mon  Tue  Wed  Thu  Fri  Sat  Sun
D15  D16  D17  D18  D19  D20  D21
 [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]  [ ]
```

Each ticked box is a completed day. Your only goal: more ticks than spaces.

PART ELEVEN: WHAT TO DO NEXT — THE 90-DAY PLAN

Day 21 is the launch pad.

The science is consistent: habits take a mean of 66 days to become automatic (Lally, European Journal of Social Psychology, 2010). At Day 21 you are approximately one-third of the way to automatic. The next 45 days are the most important.

Option 1 — Monthly Tune-Up Model

- Follow the full 21 days.
- Then maintain the core habits (protein-first, no seed oils, fasting window, daily movement, sleep) without strict day-by-day rules.
- Repeat Days 1–7 as a “reset week” at the start of each month.
- This works well for people who do well with a structured anchor but prefer flexibility between resets.

Option 2 — Continue Strict

- Repeat the full 21-day programme immediately.
- By Day 42, habits are significantly more embedded.
- Use the Week 3 reflection to slightly increase fasting intensity or movement volume in the second cycle.

Option 3 — Graduate to 90-Day Lifestyle Integration

- Keep the PERC principles as your permanent framework.
- Add more food variety as you understand your personal tolerance.
- Reintroduce foods carefully one at a time (dairy, gluten, legumes) and note responses.
- Commit to a 3-month HbA1c recheck and a medication review with your clinician.

Your Day 22 Checklist

- [ ] Book a clinician appointment for 3-month HbA1c and blood pressure review
- [ ] Choose your next-phase model (above)
- [ ] Set your ongoing weekly movement target (minimum 150 minutes)
- [ ] Keep the fasting window as your daily default
- [ ] Continue fermented and prebiotic foods daily
- [ ] Re-read the FAQ if doubts or questions arise

A FINAL NOTE

This guide is built on evidence from leading medical journals and clinical frameworks focusing on fasting, insulin regulation, protein for longevity, diabetes reversal, low-carbohydrate nutrition, and metabolic conditioning. References available on request.

21 days is a biologically real, clinically meaningful head-start — not a cure. The data is consistent: rapid reduction in carbohydrates and insulin load, combined with adequate protein, consistent movement, better sleep, and gut support, can move every measurable metabolic marker in the right direction within three weeks.

Except HbA1c. That takes 90 days. That is what Day 22 is for.

This guide is for informational purposes only. It is not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Always consult a qualified healthcare provider before making changes to your diet, exercise programme, or medication.

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PART FOUR: CHEAT SHEETS & TRACKERS

This guide includes printable cheat sheets and trackers to keep you on course:

- **Daily Non-Negotiables Checklist**
- **Fasting Windows At a Glance**

- **Approved Fats Quick Reference**
- **Zone 2 Heart Rate Guide**
- **Rapid Reset Protocol (for after a slip-up)**
- **21-Day Habit Tracker**
- **Weekly Reflection Templates**

A FINAL NOTE

This guide is built on evidence from leading medical journals and clinical frameworks from world-renowned doctors and researchers. 21 days is a biologically real, clinically meaningful head-start — not a cure. Your goal by Day 21 is to have built momentum and proven to yourself that you can make changes that move every measurable metabolic marker in the right direction.

This guide is for informational purposes only. It is not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Always consult a qualified healthcare provider before making changes to your diet, exercise programme, or medication.

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